Operational Internal Policy

1. Purpose

Establish mandatory rules for operational personnel using the WhatsApp Business channel to ensure compliance, controlled communication, and strict separation from regulated processing.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all authorized personnel with access to the WhatsApp Business channel, including:

- Customer Service
- Fraud Prevention
- Operations
- Compliance (Validation and Release functions)

2.1 Permitted Use by Function

Customer Service & Fraud Prevention

Customer Service and Fraud Prevention personnel are authorized to use WhatsApp strictly as a communication channel to:

- Communicate with verified customers
- Provide general status updates (non-decisional)
- Request or receive documentation
- Provide guidance on next steps using approved scripts

Explicit Limitations (Critical)

Customer Service and Fraud Prevention must not use WhatsApp to:

- Handle, process, or resolve complaints or disputes
- Provide transaction-specific decisions or confirmations
- Confirm transaction outcomes (approved, rejected, completed)
- Conduct investigations or provide findings
- Validate identity or documentation

➡️ Any interaction involving the above must be redirected to the appropriate official channel or system

2.2 Fraud-Related Communications

Fraud Prevention teams may:

- Communicate with customers regarding potential or suspected fraud
- Request additional information or documentation

However, they must:

- Avoid sharing specific findings, conclusions, or determinations
- Avoid confirming whether fraud has been identified or validated
- Avoid discussing internal monitoring, triggers, or investigation details

➡️ Communications must remain high-level, non-decisional, and script-based

2.3 Sensitive Information Handling

- Sensitive information (e.g., identification documents, personal data) may be received via WhatsApp
- Such information is considered unverified and not accepted for processing

➡️ Only Compliance (Validation and Release functions) is authorized to:

- Review
- Validate
- Accept
- Make decisions based on sensitive information

Customer Service, Fraud Prevention, and Operations:

- May receive and transfer only
- Must not interpret, assess, or validate

2.4 Validation and Release Authority

The following functions are strictly restricted to Compliance and authorized operational systems (Chronos):

- Identity validation
- Document verification
- Risk assessment
- Transaction approval or release
- Final decision-making

➡️ These activities must never occur within WhatsApp

2.5 Communication vs Processing Boundary

WhatsApp is:

- ✅ A communication channel
- ❌ Not a processing environment
- ❌ Not a system of record

➡️ Any activity that involves:

- Decision-making
- Case resolution
- Complaint handling
- Transaction processing

Must be performed outside WhatsApp

3. Definitions

- WhatsApp Channel: Customer communication interface only.
- Chronos: Official system of record for compliance and transactions.
- Validation: Identity and compliance review processes.
- Release: Transaction approval and execution.

4. Policy Statement

WhatsApp is strictly a communication channel. It is not authorized for validation, compliance processing, or transaction execution. All regulated activities occur exclusively within Chronos or approved systems.

5. Permitted Use

- Customer communication only
- Transaction status updates
- Documentation requests
- Clarification of next steps

6. Prohibited Use

- Processing complaints or disputes
- Transaction approval or modification
- Identity verification or KYC decisions
- SAR discussions

- Privacy rights processing
- Compliance determinations

7. Customer-Only Rule

Communication is limited to verified customers. No third-party interaction is permitted. Any third-party request must be redirected.

8. Sensitive Information Handling

Information may be received, but is not validated or accepted in WhatsApp. It must be transferred to Chronos for processing. WhatsApp is a transmission channel only.

9. Compliance Boundary

Validation and release functions are strictly performed in Chronos. WhatsApp is excluded from all compliance and decision-making processes.

10. Script Adherence

All communications must follow Compliance-approved scripts. No deviation or improvisation is allowed.

11. Escalation

Immediate escalation required for disputes, suspicious activity, privacy requests, or any boundary uncertainty.

12. Responsibilities

Personnel must enforce boundaries, provide only factual information, and ensure proper escalation and transfer of information.

13. Enforcement

Non-compliance may result in disciplinary action, including access revocation.

14. Operational Process

- Confirm customer identity
- Provide disclosure

- ☐ Respond within scope
- ☐ Receive documentation (if any)
- ☐ Transfer to Chronos
- ☐ Do not validate or approve
- ☐ Redirect if required
- ☐ Close interaction without decision implication

15. Training Requirement

All personnel must complete training prior to access. Training includes scope limitations, prohibited activities, script adherence, and escalation procedures.

Internal Roles – WhatsApp Channel

Customer Service (Primary Role)

Function: Communication and routing only

Responsibilities:

- Handle all WhatsApp interactions using approved scripts only
- Provide general assistance and basic guidance
- Acknowledge receipt of documents or requests
- Redirect/escalate:
  - Disputes → Customer Service formal channel
  - Privacy requests → Privacy channel
  - Suspicious activity → Compliance / Fraud
- Transfer all documentation to Chronos / Compliance immediately
- Maintain professional, consistent communication

Restrictions:

- No validation of identity, documents, or transactions
- No approval, denial, or status confirmation
- No interpretation or commentary on customer information
- No handling of sensitive requests (privacy, disputes, SAR)
- No deviation from scripts

Fraud Prevention

Function: Risk identification and escalation

Responsibilities:

- Monitor flagged interactions escalated from Customer Service
- Assess suspicious patterns or behaviors
- Escalate to Compliance when required
- Ensure proper documentation of risk indicators

Restrictions:

- No direct investigation or communication via WhatsApp
- No disclosure of suspicion or internal actions to the customer

Operations

Function: Process support and routing

Responsibilities:

- Ensure proper transfer of documentation to Chronos
- Support workflow continuity between teams
- Maintain operational accuracy and recordkeeping

Restrictions:

- No decision-making or validation via WhatsApp
- No customer-facing compliance communication